

Vaghesan Sundaram

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ABOUT ME

Computer Science (Cybersecurity track) and Mathematics undergraduate with hands-on experience in offensive security problem-solving, including CTFs and NSA Codebreaker Challenges, and production IT experience in a regulated environment. Strong foundation in Python scripting, network analysis, access control, and system security, with interest in penetration testing and enterprise risk reduction. Expected graduation: Spring 2027.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Community Assistant, University of Maryland

August 2025 – Present

- Provide service desk support, administrative assistance, and assist residents with diverse needs in a customer service environment.

New Jersey Courts – Ocean Vicinage — Summer Intern

June – August 2025

- Supported production IT systems in a regulated, high-availability environment, assisting staff across multiple departments.
- Managed user access, account provisioning, and workstation security, reinforcing least-privilege and secure configuration practices.
- Assisted with system updates, security patching, and configuration changes tied to compliance requirements.
- Collaborated on backup and recovery workflows, supporting data integrity and operational continuity.

Mentee, ZEB (AI Digital Transformation)

Dec 2023 – Mar 2024

- Gained exposure to AI-driven development workflows and intersections of AI and cybersecurity through structured mentorship covering model evaluation, experimentation, prompt engineering, secure software development, and data privacy.

PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

NSA Codebreaker Challenge 2025 (In Progress)

Solving staged incident response, reverse engineering, cryptography, and network analysis challenges. Using Linux, scripting, debugging, and secure coding practices to analyze unfamiliar systems and behaviors.

CompTIA Security+ (In Progress)

Studying security operations and incident response, identity and access management (IAM), authentication and access control, secure network architecture and protocols, cryptography and PKI, vulnerability management, and governance, risk, and compliance.

NSA Codebreaker Challenge 2024

Completed CTF-style challenges focused on reverse engineering, cryptography, and network exploitation. Used Python scripting, packet analysis, and systematic debugging. Contributed to University of Maryland's 30th-place finish out of 575 universities nationwide.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cybersecurity & Networking Tools	Nmap, Wireshark, Burp Suite, OpenSSL, Linux security utilities, packet analysis, vulnerability assessment
Security Concepts	Incident response, risk management, access control, IAM, MFA, cryptography, PKI, TLS, security architecture, vulnerability management
Programming & Scripting	Python, Java, C++, x86-64 Assembly, Rust, Bash, OCaml, SQL
Systems & Software	Linux, Windows, Git/GitHub, debugging, unit testing, documentation
ML / Data	PyTorch, NumPy, scikit-learn, Hugging Face, Matplotlib

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park
B.S. Computer Science (Cybersecurity Focus), Expected Spring 2027
B.S. Mathematics, Expected Spring 2027
Advanced Cybersecurity Experience for Students (ACES) – Cybersecurity Minor

GPA: 3.700

Middlesex College (MCC)
Associate Degree in Mathematics

Edison Academy Magnet School
High School Diploma

SELECTED COURSES

Discrete Mathematics • Linear Algebra • Algorithms • Computer Systems • Programming Languages
• Differential Equations • Advanced Calculus I • Technical Writing